> religion or caste or creed that has nothing to do with the business of the state. We should keep that in front of us as our ideal and you will find that in the course of time Hindus will cease to be Hindus and Muslims will cease to be Muslims, not in the religious sense because that is the personal faith of each individual, but in the political sense, as citizens of the State.

However, it does not mean that Islam has no connection with the struggle for the creation of Pakistan. One has to understand the subtlety, explained above, that Islam and Muslims are so closely related that they are not two separate entities. If Muslims of an area face threat that could cause their defeat or annihilation, they derive succour from the strength of Islam, and if Islam faces a threat, Muslims rise to resist it tooth and nail.

Allama Sir Muhammad Iqbal, the philosopher poet, explained this phenomenon in the context of the Muslims of India in his letter written to Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah on 28 May 1937 (Qureshi, 2011). The following is an excerpt from the letter:

> The Muslim has begun to believe that he has been going down and down during the last 200 years. Ordinarily he believes that his poverty is due to Hindu money lending or capitalism. The perception that it is equally due to foreign rule has not yet fully come to him. But it is bound to come. The atheistic socialism of Jawaharlal Nehru is not likely to receive much response from the Muslims. The question therefore is: how is it possible to solve the problem of Muslim poverty? And the whole future of the League depends on the League's activity to solve this question. If the League can give no such promises I am sure that Muslim masses will remain indifferent to it as before.
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> Happily there is a solution in the enforcement of the Law of Islam and its further development in the light of modern ideas. After a long and careful study of Islamic Law I have come to the conclusion that if this system of law is properly understood and applied, at last the right to subsistence is secured to everybody. But the enforcement and development of the Shariat of Islam is impossible in this country without a free Muslim state or states. This has been my honest conviction for many years and I still